THE DAILY BRIEF — AI EDITION

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AI & TECH

TSMC Just Posted Its Best Quarter Ever. On the same morning Seoul's KOSPI crashed 8%, Taiwan Semiconductor reported Q3 net income of roughly $23.55 billion — up 69% year-over-year and ahead of analyst expectations. Revenue hit $46.72 billion, about $1 billion above TSMC's own guidance, and operating margin came in at 58.7%. It was the sixth straight quarter of record profit and the eleventh consecutive quarter of growth, with high-performance computing and AI accelerators now forming the majority of revenue. CEO C.C. Wei described demand as "very robust, especially from the HPC and AI applications." Think of TSMC as the factory that builds the wafers Nvidia, Apple, AMD, and Broadcom turn into AI chips. When its order book grows like this, it's the closest thing to ground truth we have on real AI demand. (Reuters via StartupFortune)

Anthropic Discloses Q3 Revenue of $16.8 Billion Ahead of a Likely IPO. Anthropic told prospective IPO investors on Wednesday that third-quarter revenue reached $16.8 billion, up from $11.6 billion in Q2 and $4.7 billion in Q1, putting the company on track for a 2026 revenue run-rate above $50 billion. Growth is sequential but decelerating — 45% in Q3 versus the larger step from Q1 to Q2 — and Anthropic said it is profitable on an adjusted basis. The slowing acceleration is what spooked Korean chip stocks on Thursday. (Reuters)

Anthropic's Mythos Model Is Now Reshaping Bank Cybersecurity Budgets. Bank of America CEO Brian Moynihan revealed on Wednesday's earnings call that the bank hired 1,000 contractors in Q2 to patch software vulnerabilities that Mythos had discovered across systems used by staff and outside vendors. That is on top of BofA's existing 3,000-person security team, and the company has spent "a couple hundred million plus" on remediation plus anti-money-laundering fixes tied to a separate $1.2 billion Treasury penalty. JPMorgan's Jamie Dimon told Bloomberg that cybersecurity risks "went up 10-fold" after Mythos's release. (CNBC via Business Insider)

- TSMC: https://startupfortune.com/tsmc-posts-record-profit-as-ai-chip-demand-defies-market-debt-fears
- Anthropic Q3 revenue: https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/anthropics-q3-revenue-surges-45-nearly-17-billion-2026-10-14/
- BofA Mythos remediation: https://www.businessinsider.com/bank-of-america-hired-contractors-protect-software-rogue-ai-agents-2026-10

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